UNIVERSITY of WASHINGTON

Software Design for Data Science

Giving Presentations

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University of Washington
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Bad presentations bore your listeners!

Confession 1: this lecture contains my personal opinions

Confession 2: I know I'm a hypocrite

Advice 1: Slides are not for reading

Too much text on a slide is distracting and redundant.

- People struggle with reading and listening at the same time.
- You audience may be trying to read the slide instead of listening to you.
- If you read it word-for-word, it's redundant. What's the point of you even being there?
- It can be overwhelming and cause your listeners to glaze over and not remember anything.
- It's not immediately clear what the most important takeaways are.
- Full sentences contain lots of words that aren't actually important to your point.

How much did you hate this slide?

Advice 1: Slides are not for reading

Reading

+ Listening

= confusion + boredom

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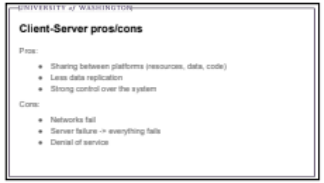
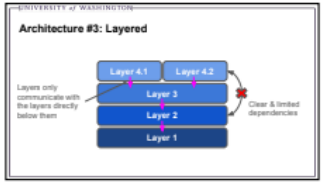
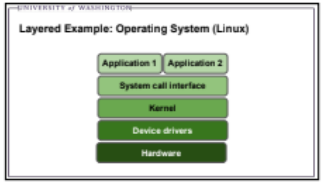
Advice 1: Slides are not for reading

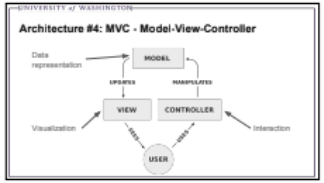
- Limit text on each slide
  - No full sentences
  - Illustrative images
  - Short bulleted lists if needed
- Don’t read your slides!

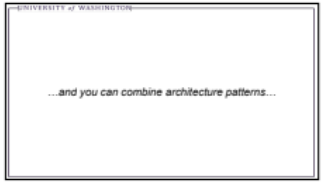
Advice 2 (1b): Slides are not for handouts

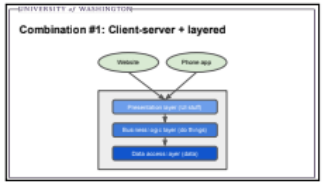


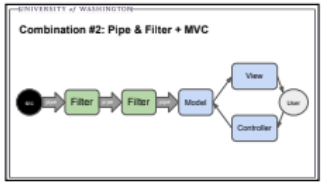


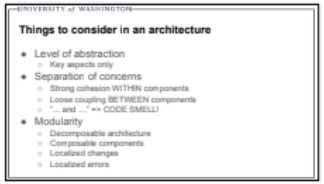












Advice 3: Styling your slides

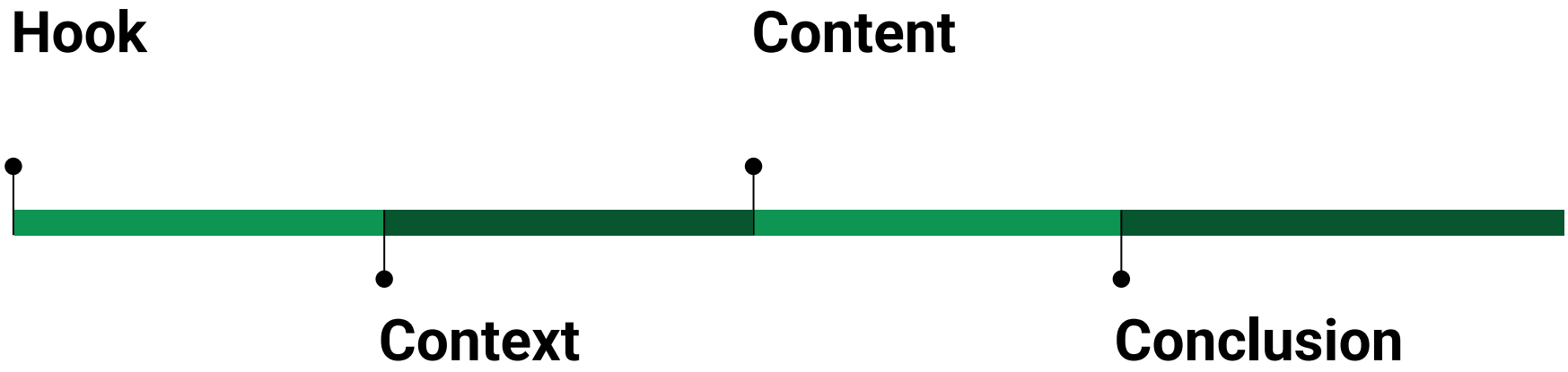
Illustrative images

Big fonts!

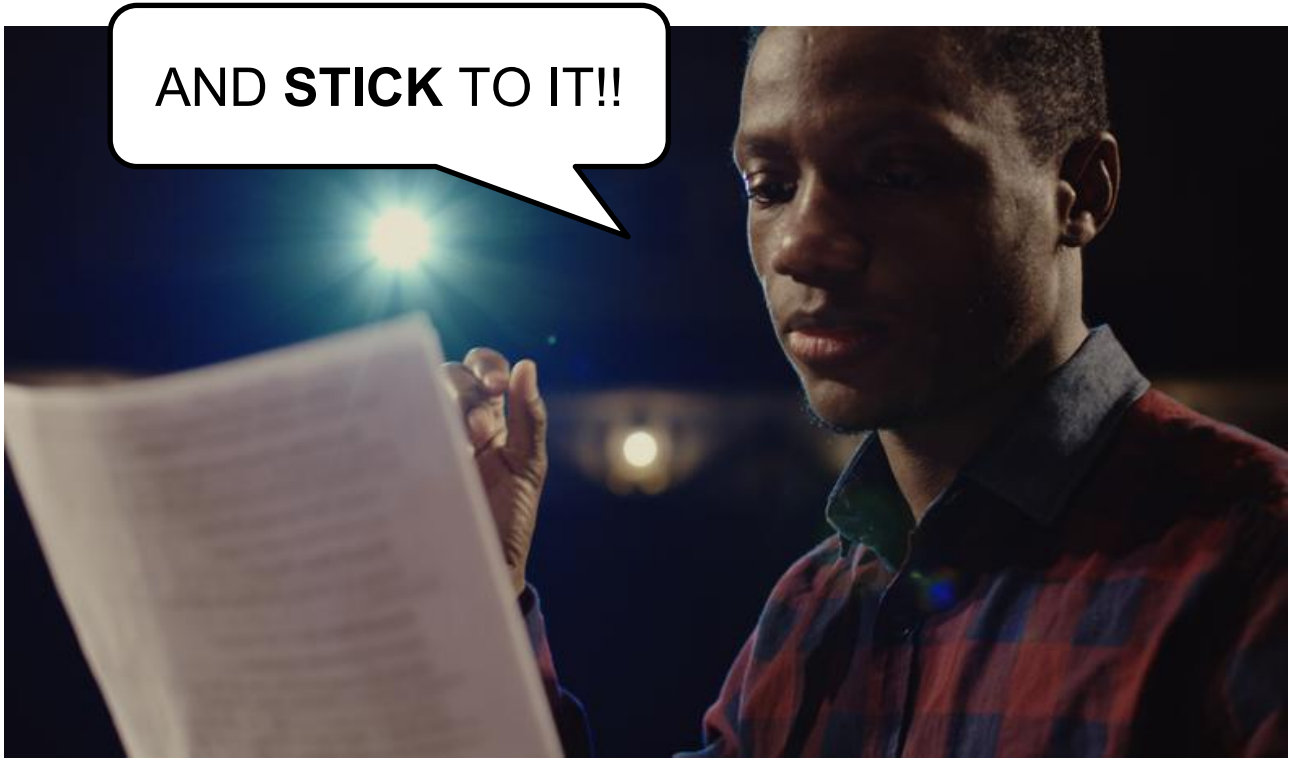
Don’t be afraid of white space

ANIMATIONS

Advice 4: Tell a story



Advice 5: Prepare a script



Advice 6: Live demos

Fake ‘em, don’t make ‘em

(prepare a screen recording and narrate over it)

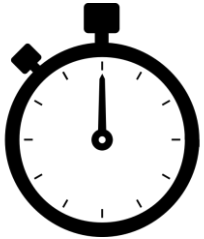
Advice 7: Interactivity

Ask questions / involve the audience with interactive elements

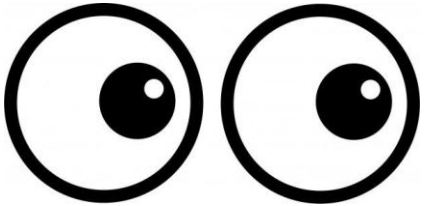
Advice 8: Practice

Your script

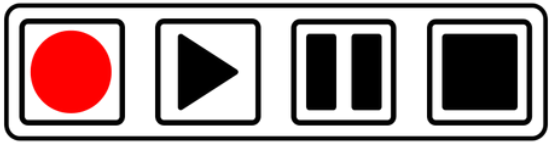
Enthusiasm



Timing



Eye contact



Record yourself

Your DATA 515 final presentations

- 10 minutes
- Some of the “story” is already specified
- Strive for
  - Timing
  - No walls of text
  - Scripted
  - Enthusiasm